

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

FREE

AI Literacy • Free Frame • Any Story

THE NEWS DESK PACK • FRAME 1

# Fact Desk

Any story. Check it  
before you repeat it.

Grades 6–8

1 one-page frame

No prep • No devices needed



FOR THE TEACHER • FREE FRAME

# Teacher Guide



Fact Desk, Frame 1 of the News Desk pack: routine, safe-story rules, script, strong answer, rubric. You play editor, not answer key.

## THE ROUTINE

**45 min: Open 5** — headline only; "What question does this make you want to ask?" • **Read 10** — read once, underline claims, pairs retell in one sentence • **Frame 20** — solo 12 (steps in order), pair-check 8 (swap, read the evidence, ask one question, fix one thing; "So what?" last) • **Share-out 10** — one line per pair, stamp plus evidence; tally RUN / FIX / KILL.

**25 min: Open 2** • **Read 5** (you read it aloud once; one volunteer retells) • **Frame 15** (solo, no pair-check) • **Share-out 3** (three volunteers). Collect; the "So what?" lines are the exit ticket.

## HOW TO PICK A SAFE STORY

- Two sources or it doesn't exist.** Two outlets that did not copy each other, or it's a rumor.
- "Alleged" for any lawsuit.** A court hasn't decided. "The musicians allege", never "the company copied".
- Officeholders as officeholders.** "The mayor announced", not the name. Students frame the decision; the person is not the lesson.
- If students must pick a political side, skip it.** A rule, a price, a Ge app, a hack, a new tool: in. A party, a candidate, a vote: out.
- Never a story that shames a family.** No crime stories with names, no viral videos of kids, nobody a student could be related to.

## FACT DESK SCRIPT — SAY IT WHILE YOU CIRCULATE

"Underline anything with a name, a date, a number, a place or a quote in it. If it can be checked, it's a claim."  
 "A second source is not where you first saw it. Same video, same account, same AI: doesn't count." "The stamp is the easy part. Your evidence is the grade."

**Strong answer:** three or more claims copied exactly, each with a specific kind of second source (a museum site, an encyclopedia entry, the team's own schedule), one stamp, and an evidence line that says whether the story's point still stands.

## THE RUBRIC ROW — SCORES THE WHOLE FRAME

|                  | STRONG (3)                                                                                                                                                     | GETTING THERE (2)                                                                                                           | NOT YET (1)                                                                                                                        |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Fact Desk</b> | One stamp, checked once. Claims copied exactly, each with a specific second source. Every step shows. The "So what?" says why it matters to someone their age. | A stamp with general evidence ("it says so"), or one step skipped; the verdict still holds. "So what?" matters to "people". | Stamp only, or two stamps. Table blank, or the second source is where they first saw it. "So what?" blank or repeats the headline. |

## FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- ISTE 1.3.b** — Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources. *Taught: step 3. Assessed: the "Second source" column.*
- CCSS ELA RI.6.8** — Trace and evaluate the argument and specific claims in a text, distinguishing claims that are supported by reasons and evidence from claims that are not. *Taught: steps 1–2. Assessed: verdict + "My evidence".*
- CCSS ELA W.6.1** — Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence. *Taught: step 4. Assessed: "My evidence" + "So what?".*